ALAGAPPA UNIVERSITY

(Accredited with "A+" Grade by NAAC (CGPA:3.64) in the Third Cycle & Graded as Category-I University and Granted Autonomy by MHRD-UGC)

KARAIKUDI – 630 003

Date:22.12.2019

The 35th Edition of the Five-day South Zone Inter University Youth Festival concluded here at Alagappa University, Karaikudi today. 1253 students representing 36 South Indian Universities showcased their artistic talents in 27 events conducted at the mega cultural fete sponsored by the Association of Indian Universities (AIU), New Delhi and hosted by Alagappa University, Karaikudi.

<u>The University of Kerala, Thiruvananthapuram is the overall winner, and the Calicut University, Calicut, is the runner.</u>

Prof. N. Rajendran, Vice-Chancellor, Alagappa University, presiding over the valedictory function, said it is a red letter day in the annals of Alagappa University as it has hosted this huge cultural event for the first time on the campus. The University which has acquired a niche for its academic excellence at the national level is also giving importance to extracurricular activities such as sports and cultural activities. He added that India has all along been giving importance to finer aspects of culture which are intrinsic part of Indian life. The aim of fine arts in Indian ethos has been one of spiritual and ethical elevation. By hosting this cultural festival Alagappa University has done its part to uphold the tradition of our land appropriately in the Tamil month of Markazhi which is glorified as the month of music and dance. The Vice-Chancellor recalled how the mammoth festival began on a note of jubilation on 18.12.2019 morning with a massive rally taken out by the participants from South Indian Universities. The two-hour procession was a grand spectacle showcasing the typical cultures of the regions.

Prof. Rajan Kr.Kakati, AIU Observer, Guwahati University, Guwahati, while offering felicitations, said that the objective of conducting this festival is to bring forth the hidden artistic talents and potentialities of the youth so as to encourage them to become as artistes. He added that the beautiful green, clean and vast Alagappa University Campus is highly suitable for conducting cultural festivals not only at the South Zone level but also at the National level. He lauded the hosts for organising everything in an excellent manner.

The Ghatam maestro and Grammy award winner renowned percussionist Padma Shri, Padma Bhushan Thiru.Vikku.T.H.Vinayakram, in his valedictory address, referred to his pleasant experience of performing a ghatam recital at the United Nations and said that Chettinad region has been supporting artists by giving them chances to perform in temple and other festivals and functions. A brief ghatam recital by him accompanied by his grandson Mr.S.Swaminathan on kanjira was a great attraction at the function that enthralled young audience who responded to beat of rhythm with great enthusiasm and involvement.

Members of the Syndicate Dr.R.Swaminathan and Prof. T.R.Gurumoorthy offered felicitations.

Earlier Prof. H. Gurumallesh Prabu, Registrar, welcomed the gathering and Dr.M.Jothi Basu, Organising Secretary, read the report of the five-day activities. Dr.P.Eswaran, Co-organizing secretary, proposed a vote of thanks. 28 Committees consisting of more than 150 had made excellent arrangements for the smooth conduct of this festival.

Prof.H.Gurumallesh Prabu

Registrar